

♦ Introduction

“Thank you so much for taking the time to speak with me today. It’s a real privilege to have the opportunity to learn from your extensive experience leading risk functions at Morgan Stanley. I’ve gone through your professional journey, and I’m truly inspired by the depth and breadth of your leadership across financial, model, and supervisory risk. I’ve prepared a few questions that I hope will allow us to explore your perspectives on risk, leadership, and innovation in depth.”

♦ Interview Questions

1. Strategic Evolution of Risk

“Over your extensive career in risk management, how have you seen the role of the 1st line of defense evolve, especially in wealth management?”

Follow-up: How has that influenced your approach to designing effective supervisory frameworks?

2. Innovation vs. Control

“When overseeing both financial and model risks, how do you strike the right balance between robust governance and enabling innovation?”

3. AI and Model Risk Governance

“As head of model risk governance, how do you evaluate the increasing use of AI and machine learning models in wealth management?”

Follow-up: Do you feel that traditional model validation processes remain sufficient in this evolving space?

4. Model Risk in Digital Platforms

“What qualities do you consider most critical in a model risk framework when models directly impact client-facing digital platforms?”

5. Challenges in Product Risk

“During your time chairing the New Product Committee, what types of risks were most difficult to anticipate when introducing new products to the WM platform?”

6. Risk as a Strategic Partner

“How do you ensure the risk function is viewed as a strategic partner during product development rather than a control gatekeeper?”

7. Global Experience

“Having worked extensively in both London and New York, how has international exposure shaped your risk philosophy?”

Follow-up: What regional differences do you observe in how risk is managed or prioritized?

8. Fostering Risk Culture

“In your experience leading multiple risk committees, what practices have been most effective in fostering a strong risk culture at the leadership level?”

9. Supervision Across Business Models

“When designing supervisory frameworks for both the Financial Advisor and Digital Direct channels, what distinct challenges do you face, and how do you address them?”

10. Measuring Framework Effectiveness

“What metrics or indicators do you rely on to assess whether a risk supervision framework is truly effective and sustainable over time?”

♦ Closing Statement

“Thank you again for sharing your insights. It’s incredibly valuable to hear firsthand how you’ve approached complex risk challenges and shaped key functions within the firm. I’ve learned a great deal from this conversation, and I truly appreciate your time and leadership.”

Potential Interview Topics/Question Ideas

1. Strategic Leadership in Risk

- *“How have your risk management frameworks evolved with the increasing complexity of financial products?”*
- *“Can you share a pivotal moment where your decision significantly influenced risk outcomes at Morgan Stanley?”*

2. Model and Market Risk Governance

- *“With the rise of AI/ML in financial models, how is model risk being approached today?”*
- *“What best practices do you believe are essential in managing model risk across a large WM platform?”*

3. Supervisory Frameworks

- *“What are the biggest challenges in designing supervision for digital vs FA channels?”*
- *“How do you ensure alignment between risk frameworks and business growth?”*

4. Innovation vs Risk

- *“How do you balance the need to innovate with risk containment, especially in product development?”*

5. Global Perspective

- *“Having managed risk functions in both the UK and US, how do regulatory and cultural differences shape your approach?”*

6. Committee Leadership

- *“How do you ensure effective governance in risk-related committees across such a wide scope of responsibilities?”*

Summary of Profile – Managing Director at Morgan Stanley

Current Role: Head of Financial and Model Risk & Supervision (May 2023 – Present)

- **Location:** New York, USA
- **Scope:**
 - Oversees all *Financial Risks* (Credit and Market) from a **1st line of defense** perspective.
 - Responsible for *financial model governance* across the Wealth Management (WM) business.

- Designs and supervises *risk frameworks* for both the *Financial Advisor* and *Digital Direct* channels.
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Previous Key Roles:

1. Head of Product, Market, Model and Credit Risk (Jan 2018 – Apr 2023)

- Chaired Wealth Management's **New Product** and **Franchise Risk Committees**.
- Led all **Model, Market, and Credit Risk Management**.

2. Chair of MSWM New Product Committee & Head of Product & Investment Risk (Jan 2012 – Dec 2017)

- Oversaw risks associated with **\$1.7 trillion AUM**.
- Focused on risk management for **product vetting** and **in-house discretionary asset management**.

3. Global Product, Operational & Investment Risk Manager, MSSB (Jan 2011 – Dec 2011)

- Covered global **product, investment, and operational risks**.
- Chaired several risk committees:
 - *Operational Risk Committee*
 - *Investment Risk, Compliance & Control Committee*
 - *International Credit Committee* (oversight on client derivatives and margin lending up to \$50M)
- **Conflict Management Officer** for EMEA and Asia-Pacific.

4. Managing Director, Global Risk Manager, Private Wealth Mgmt (Jun 2008 – Dec 2010)

- Led global PWM risk management.
- Oversaw **investment, suitability, credit/collateral, and operational risks**.

- Served as **Conflict Management Officer** and **Wall Crossing Manager** in London.
5. **Executive Director, International Risk Manager, Global Wealth Management (Jan 2005 – Jun 2008)**
- Focused on the **international wealth management** business (ex-US).
 - Responsible for developing infrastructure for identifying and mitigating various risk types.
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Key Themes & Areas of Expertise

- **Comprehensive Risk Management** across all dimensions: investment, market, model, operational, product, and credit.
- **Strong leadership** in *governance, supervision frameworks, and committee chairing* roles.
- **Global perspective**, having worked in both **London** and **New York** across international and domestic businesses.
- Deep involvement in **first-line risk management**, particularly in **wealth management** and **private wealth sectors**.
- Proven track record in **designing controls and infrastructure** to manage high-value risk exposures effectively.
- **Navigating Uncertainty:**

In today's environment of geopolitical tension, trade wars, and rising tariffs, how do you factor macro risk into the design of financial risk and supervisory frameworks at the firm?

- **Portfolio & Balance Sheet Impact:**

How do current global headwinds—such as US-China relations or shifting interest rate expectations—impact the risk profile of MSWM's balance sheet and investment offerings?

- **Geopolitical Risk Preparedness:**

Are there frameworks or tools you've found particularly effective for scenario planning

around geopolitical shocks or global policy shifts?



Digital Assets, Crypto, and New-Age Risks

4. **Crypto Risk Assessment:**

How do you approach the risk governance of newer asset classes like cryptocurrencies, especially given their volatility, regulatory uncertainty, and model unpredictability?

5. **Model Risk for Digital Assets:**

Do digital assets challenge the traditional assumptions that risk models rely on? How do you adapt model validation or supervision strategies accordingly?

6. **Crypto in Wealth Portfolios:**

As clients increasingly explore digital assets, how does Morgan Stanley Wealth Management ensure suitability, education, and risk oversight for such high-risk/high-interest products?



Risk Strategy in a Shifting Economic Landscape

7. **Stress Testing in a Volatile World:**

How have your approaches to stress testing or scenario analysis evolved in response to today's macroeconomic volatility and market disruptions?

8. **Balancing Innovation & Risk Amid Uncertainty:**

With the dual pressures of market innovation (e.g., fintech, AI, crypto) and macroeconomic headwinds, how do you prioritize what gets risk-managed and what gets fast-tracked?